L@S'24 Submission 1358

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# L@S'24 Submission 1358

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| Submission 1358 | |
|---|---|
| Title | Authenticated Personalized "Study With Me" Groups |
| Paper | (Apr 16, 16:20) (previous versions) |
| Video | |
| SupplementaryMaterials | (Apr 16, 11:54) |
| Author keywords | Human-centered computing<br>Quantitative Research<br>Educational Technology<br>Virtual Study Groups<br>Social Engagement<br>Accountability<br>Online Education |
| | The current form of social engagement in online programs and courses is discussion threads and forums. However, the various ways in which students connect have evolved to students studying on YouTube and Bilibili with streamers who live stream themselves studying for companionship, and viewers join and share their daily goals in the comments. Discord has seen a boom of educational |

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| Abstract | The current form of social engagement in online programs and courses is discussion threads and forums. However, the various ways in which students connect have evolved to students studying on YouTube and Bilibili with streamers who live stream themselves studying for companionship, and viewers join and share their daily goals in the comments. Discord has seen a boom of educational servers where students show their aesthetic work desks or screen-share their work. All these students are from different time zones and different courses. No platform exists where students from the same class or college can study online together. This study shows the necessity for a large-scale social engagement platform authenticated with the university portal, removing the need for moderators or teaching assistants to monitor these students continuously. This study also analyses the different applications that currently exist to support this large-scale implementation. Quantitative research was conducted by sharing a survey containing a prototype of an authenticated study group with the human-computer interaction class from the Online Master's in Computer Science at Georgia Institute of Technology. The results showed that 84% of the students are willing to use this platform. Accountability tools have also been analyzed and no tool exists that guides students in real-time to improvise on their studying habits or guide them to approach things differently. With more educational programs available online, the future of learning at scale needs an authenticated platform for social engagement as well as personalized guidance. |
| Submitted | Apr 16, 11:54 |
| Last update | |
| Submission Category | Work-in-Progress (max. 4 pages) |
| Undergraduate Student Authorship | No |
| Graduate Student | Yes |

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| Abstract | The current form of social engagement in online programs and courses is discussion threads and forums. However, the various ways in which students connect have evolved to students studying on YouTube and Bilibili with streamers who live stream themselves studying for companionship, and viewers join and share their daily goals in the comments. Discord has seen a boom of educational servers where students show their aesthetic work desks or screen-share their work. All these students are from different time zones and different courses. No platform exists where students from the same class or college can study online together. This study shows the necessity for a large-scale social engagement platform authenticated with the university portal, removing the need for moderators or teaching assistants to monitor these students continuously. This study also analyses the different applications that currently exist to support this large-scale implementation. Quantitative research was conducted by sharing a survey containing a prototype of an authenticated study group with the human-computer interaction class from the Online Master's in Computer Science at Georgia Institute of Technology. The results showed that 84% of the students are willing to use this platform. Accountability tools have also been analyzed and no tool exists that guides students in real-time to improvise on their studying habits or guide them to approach things differently. With more educational programs available online, the future of learning at scale needs an authenticated platform for social engagement as well as personalized guidance. |
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| Last update | |
| Submission Category | Work-in-Progress (max. 4 pages) |
| Undergraduate Student Authorship | No |
| Graduate Student Authorship | Yes |
| Dataset Contribution | Yes |
| Topics | The use of generative AI to scale learning<br>The evaluation of existing systems<br>Scaling learning in informal contexts<br>Research that addresses accessibility in learning |
| Author conflicts | none |

**Authors**

| First name | Last name | Email | Country | Affiliation | Web page | Corresponding? |
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| Nirali | Thakkar | nirali@gatech.edu | India | Georgia Institute of Technology | http://www.linkedin.com/in/niralii | ✓ |

Reviews

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Reviews

**Review 1**

| | |
|---|---|
| *Overall evaluation* | **1**: weak accept<br>Summary:<br><br>This paper introduces an Authenticated Personalized "Study with Me" Groups platform to enhance social engagement and accountability in online studying. The key takeaway is the potential of this platform to provide personalized guidance and foster a sense of community among students studying together online.<br><br>Review:<br><br>The work is well motivated as it addresses the evolving ways in which students connect for studying online and the need for a platform that allows students from the same class or college to study together. The problem is clearly articulated, highlighting the lack of platforms for authenticated social engagement in online studying. The methodology appears sound, incorporating quantitative research through surveys and prototype testing to analyze the feasibility and acceptance of the proposed platform among students. Overall, I think this is a promising work, and I can imagine students could benefit from this community-aware, personalized accountability platform. |
| *Reviewer's confidence* | **3**: Confident - I am knowledgable in the area |

**Review 2**

| | |
|---|---|
| *Overall* | **-2**: reject<br>The paper proposes a platform to provide a virtual learning 'space' authenticated through the university portal. Quantitative research was conducted with 73 postgraduate students using surveys. The results show that most participants were willing to use the proposed platform in the future. The authors argue that authenticated study groups have the potential to offer better connecting features and personalized settings.<br><br>The topic of a social engagement platform is intriguing. However, the paper's contribution is not sufficiently clear and strong.<br><br>Firstly, there is a lack of discussion about the educational significance of the proposed platform. The importance of authentication and its potential for enhancing learning support are not adequately addressed. Additionally, the concept of 'personalized' needs further consideration. It appears that personalization stems from users' ability to customize settings and personal information, which differs from the personalized guidance mentioned in the abstract. More extensive literature review is needed to provide a stronger theoretical basis for the paper. |

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| *confidence* | **3**: Confident - I am knowledgable in the area |

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| *Overall evaluation* | **-2**: reject<br>The paper proposes a platform to provide a virtual learning 'space' authenticated through the university portal. Quantitative research was conducted with 73 postgraduate students using surveys. The results show that most participants were willing to use the proposed platform in the future. The authors argue that authenticated study groups have the potential to offer better connecting features and personalized settings.<br><br>The topic of a social engagement platform is intriguing. However, the paper's contribution is not sufficiently clear and strong.<br><br>Firstly, there is a lack of discussion about the educational significance of the proposed platform. The importance of authentication and its potential for enhancing learning support are not adequately addressed. Additionally, the concept of 'personalized' needs further consideration. It appears that personalization stems from users' ability to customize settings and personal information, which differs from the personalized guidance mentioned in the abstract. More extensive literature review is needed to provide a stronger theoretical basis for the paper.<br><br>Secondly, there is a lack of detailed description regarding the research method and results. Although the authors mention using surveys to gather users' perceptions of the platform, there is no basic description of the survey or the study procedure. Moreover, the quantitative results are inadequately described; the paper only references a few numbers from the graphs without conducting reliability and validity analyses. Furthermore, no discussion is provided based on these results.<br><br>Lastly, while the paper describes many details of the platform design, no relevant theory or previous work is mentioned to support the design decisions. If the paper positions its contribution on the platform's design, it is essential to explain how these design decisions were made.<br><br>Overall, it is a promising start, but significant work is still needed. It would be beneficial if the authors could address the following questions: 1) What is the research gap? 2) How does the proposed work address this gap? 3) What evidence supports the proposed solution? |
| *Reviewer's confidence* | **3**: Confident - I am knowledgable in the area |

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